

ceremony can be performed again the following year to regain the point of Stamina.

Taboo: Cottonwood requires her children to be frugal in their use of her wood, replacing cut trees with seedlings whenever possible. She also demands that her children never fail to honor the spirits when harvesting any plant.

Dogwood

Background Cost: 3

Flowering dogwood grows along most of the eastern seaboard of North America, from as far north as Ontario to as far south as the Gulf coast. Valued for her hard wood, used in making all sorts of tools, dogwood's bark also has many medicinal properties. Her first spring blooms are a sign to farmers that it is time to begin planting. Dogwood is lively and helpful, although she can be somewhat vain with the knowledge that her pink or white flowers make her one of the loveliest trees.

Traits: Dogwood endows her Nunnehi children with an additional dot of Charisma, as well as 2 dots of Medicine.

Taboo: Dogwood's children may never deface themselves (tattoos and piercings are prohibited).

Fir

Fir goes by many names, among them spruce, Fraser, and balsam, and in all her forms, she is a survivor. Fir can withstand cold climates and rocky ground that is inhospitable to other species of trees. Being a coniferous tree, fir does not shed its leaves each year, and the cones she produces not only give birth to new fir trees, but also provide nourishment for many creatures of the forest.

Background Cost: 2

Traits: Fir grants her children an additional dot of Stamina and Survival.

Taboo: Fir demands that her children never cut down a fir tree, and to only use deadwood.

Fireweed

Background Cost: 2

Fireweed is noted for its striking magenta blooms, and thrives in normally-inhospitable lands, such as areas ravaged by wildfires or areas distressed by excavations. She also makes her home in the fertile soil of the Rockies and the higher Appalachians. Fireweed symbolizes the power of plant life to renew itself, restoring growth and beauty to lands gutted by humans or nature. She is tenacious and hardy, and respects those qualities in others. Native tribes relied on fireweed as a food source, eating the shoots, making soup from the stems, and brewing tea from the leaves. Her roots and leaves also have great medicinal value.

Traits: Fireweed grants her children an additional dot of Stamina and Medicine.

Taboo: Fireweed requires her children to respect natural places and aid in the restoration of those places whenever possible.

Granite

Background Cost: 3

Granite forms much of the geological backbone of the American continent, and can be found deep beneath the Appalachian Mountains or in exposed rocky ridges throughout other regions. He appears hard and unyielding, but is also a symbol for stability and stoicism.

Traits: Granite grants his children 1 additional dot of Strength and 2 dots of Intimidation.

Taboo: Granite demands that his children never back down from a test of strength or endurance.

Maize

Background Cost: 3

Maize (corn) is a staple crop of many Native American tribes and a close ally of Blue Corn Woman, a chief spirit of the Upper World. It is an exception among totems in that it is almost only found cultivated, but maize spirits can usually only be found in fields grown by native tribes. Besides being a food staple, powdered maize is often dusted over a family's sacred possessions to feed the spirits. Maize is a regal spirit, concerned with ceremony, yet she also has a deep desire to nourish and protect those who honor her.

Traits: Nunnehi who choose maize as a totem gain a dot each of Wits, Crafts, and Empathy.

Taboo: A child of maize must hang an ear of corn somewhere in his dwelling and keep a few kernels of corn on his person at all times.

Saguaro Cactus

Background Cost: 2

Saguaro thrives in the dryness of the southwestern deserts, towering over the other plant life and dominating the landscape. His spiny limbs arch upward, forming a link between earth and sky. The Papago of Arizona use the succulent's bright red, plum-sized fruit in brewing a syrupy liquor, which they consume as a part of their rainmaking ceremonies. Saguaro is proud and hardy, proof that even the barren desert can sustain life.

Traits: Nunnehi who are allied with Saguaro gain an additional dot each of Stamina and Survival.

Taboo: Saguaro requires his children to conserve water, and oppose those who pollute or waste water sources.

Sandstone

Background Cost: 2

Sandstone can be found near areas of fresh and salt water, and in arid regions such as deserts. The Navajo grind her colorful stones into fine sand for use in their elaborate and beautiful sand paintings, which are used in many of their ceremonies. Pieces of sandstone with natural, water-worn holes are also said to be sacred. Sandstone is strong yet flexible, willing to participate in both the practical and spiritual affairs of those who respect her.

Traits: Children of sandstone gain an additional dot of both Manipulation and Occult.